

Your master's search — the complete guide

Everything gathered across five separate searches, in one document. Sound design · music production · audio engineering · music technology · music business. Target intake: **September 2027**.

What you're holding

1,091 unique opportunities across 56 countries — master's programmes at public and private institutions, plus every scholarship scheme attached to them. Merged and de-duplicated from five searches that ran over several weeks:

Search	Found	What it covered
Worldwide sweep	539	Every region, every funding scheme, all five subject tracks
Deep Europe	102	Follow-up on every European country individually
Sound design deep dive	319	Conservatoires, film schools, private academies across Europe
Private ES/PT/NL/IT	198	Private institutions in four countries, with accreditation checked
Europe gap sweep	104	Everything the first four missed, public and private

Everything was searched **in English and in the local language** — *Tontechnik, conception sonore, realizacja dźwięku, musica elettronica, hangmérnök, ses tasarımı* — because English-only searching misses most of this field.

The companion spreadsheet is **MASTER-all-opportunities.xlsx**. This document explains what's in it and what it means. The spreadsheet is where you filter and decide.

Nothing was dropped. The five source files hold **1,262 records** between them. Merging them on institution + programme collapses the overlaps to **1,091 unique rows** — and I checked every source file back against the master: **0 records from any of the five are unrepresented**. Where the same programme was found twice, the richer record wins and any field the winner was missing is filled in from the other, so de-duplication adds detail rather than losing it.

First: is it actually a master's degree?

Not everything sold as a "Master" is one. Every record was re-checked against **what it actually awards**, and the verdict now sits in **column D — Qualification level** of both workbooks.

Verdict	Records	What it means
Master's degree	889	A real second-cycle award — M.Sc., M.A., M.Mus., M.Phil., <i>mestrado, laurea magistrale / diploma accademico di II livello, máster universitario oficial, magisterský, yüksek lisans</i> . This is what you want
Master di I livello	10	Italian first-level master — 60 CFU, one year, taken <i>after</i> a bachelor. Not a second cycle, no PhD access

Verdict	Records	What it means
Not a degree	133	<i>Título propio / máster propio</i> , CRKBO or NRTD diploma, <i>pós-graduação</i> , advanced diploma, short course
Bachelor / first cycle	2	You already hold one of these
Funding scheme	23	Money, not a qualification
Aggregate entry	24	A summary row covering many institutions at once
Unclear	10	The page does not say plainly enough — email and ask

889 of the 1,091 records award a genuine master's degree. 145 do not. Nothing was deleted: the rejects sit on their own **NOT a degree** — **avoid** tab so you can check the reasoning.

All your top-rated options survive this test — TU Ilmenau, HfK Bremen, Kunstuni Linz, Saint Louis Rome, MTU Cork, ČVUT Prague, Žilina, Tbilisi and UCP Porto are every one of them real degrees.

One correction worth knowing: ESMUC Barcelona is a genuine *public* conservatoire, but four of its "Masters" are *màster propi* — its own title, not a state-validated one. A public institution is not automatically a guarantee.

The full breakdown, the country-by-country trap, and the complete list of the 145 rejects are in **DEGREE - CHECK.md**.

Your profile, which every judgement here is based on

- Tunisian national — **you need a student visa for everywhere in this document.** This constraint does more work than any other
- BSc Software Engineering, SMU MedTech, graduating now
- **No music degree. No conservatoire training. No professional audio experience.** No portfolio yet
- **Arabic native, French fluent, English working. IELTS/TOEFL not yet taken**
- Goal: international DJ and music producer
- Funding: fully funded strongly preferred; partial fine; self-pay only if genuinely cheap

How to read "chance of acceptance"

Every row carries a **Chance for you** column with three values, plus a **Why** column giving the actual reason. This is the column that does most of the work, so it matters that you understand exactly what it is — and what it isn't.

	Meaning	What triggers it
Strong	The published entry rules name your background, or accept any bachelor's	<i>"any bachelor's degree", "computer science", "engineering", "telecomunicaciones o informática"</i>
Possible	Plausible, but something needs asking or arguing	<i>"or related field", "or equivalent",</i> hedged wording like <i>"may qualify — confirm with us"</i> , or silence on the question
Weak	Something you don't have is required	A music degree, a live audition, professional audio experience, or a teaching language you don't speak

What this is not. It is computed from the entry text each institution publishes — not from an admissions officer, not from acceptance statistics, and not from your actual application. It is a filter to save you weeks of reading, not a prediction. **Always read the "Entry requirements" and "Why that chance" columns before ruling something in or out.**

How it was checked. I validated it against a dozen programmes whose answers I already knew, and it caught real errors in my own logic:

- *Conservatorium van Amsterdam, Immersive Audio* was scoring **Strong** because the word "software" appeared in the record. Its actual entry text demands *"a bachelor's degree in Music" and "significant experience in audio engineering at a professional level."* Now **Weak**
- *HfM Detmold Musikregie* was scoring Strong; it is a top-up on an existing **Tonmeister** bachelor. Now **Weak** — while Detmold's *M.Sc. Music Acoustics*, which does list Physics and Acoustics as comparable, correctly sits at **Possible**
- Programmes taught in a language you don't speak are **downgraded even when the entry rules are wide open** — Ankara accepts literally any bachelor's, but it teaches in Turkish, so it is Possible rather than Strong

Across 1,091 records: **423 Strong · 435 Possible · 233 Weak** — and **199 of them additionally carry a WORTH IT / CONDITIONAL / AVOID verdict** from the verification pass (see below). 209 verdicts were issued in total; 199 survive de-duplication into the master file.

What verification actually found

209 records were re-checked against their official pages by a second agent and given a verdict for *your* profile. Both verification passes are now complete — 70 agents, zero failures.

Verdict	Count	Meaning
WORTH IT	18	Accredited, affordable, and genuinely open to you
CONDITIONAL	74	Real, but with a caveat you must resolve first
AVOID	117	Wrong qualification, wrong subject, unaffordable, or closed to you

The most important number here: in the private sector, 84 of 127 verified options — 66% — came back AVOID, and only 3 came back WORTH IT. In the public-heavy gap sweep the AVOID rate is 40% of 82, and 15 came back WORTH IT. That gap is the clearest single argument in this whole search for pointing yourself at public institutions.

The 18 that survived verification

Rated A — apply to these

Programme	Where	Cost	Language
TU Ilmenau — Medieningenieurwissenschaften	Ilmenau	Free + €332/sem	English or German
HfK Bremen — Digital Media	Bremen	€431/semester	English
MTU Cork — MA Music and Technology	Cork	€13,500	English
Saint Louis Rome — Sound Design & Post Produzione	Rome	~€8.5k/yr	Italian + English
Saint Louis Rome — Music Production	Rome	~€8.5k/yr	Italian + English
Conservatorio Verdi Milano — Musica Elettronica	Milan	€3,500/yr	Italian
Conservatorio Rovigo — Musica Applicata, Sound	Rovigo	income-scaled	Italian
Kunstuniversität Linz — Interface Cultures	Linz	near-free	English
ČVUT Prague — Electronics and Communications	Prague	cheap	English
Buckinghamshire New University — MA Music and Audio Production		£16,280	English

Plus one that isn't a programme at all

Italian regional DSU right-to-study scholarship	Rated A — the only public money in four countries that a Tunisian at a <i>private</i> institution can actually receive. Details in the funding section below
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Rated B — strong, with a caveat

Kunstuniversität Linz *Timebased Media* · UPHF Valenciennes *Ingénierie* · University of Žilina *Multimedia Engineering* · **Ankara MGÜ Müzik Teknolojileri** · Dokuz Eylül *Music Technology* · Hertfordshire *Music Production and Artist Development* · University of South Wales *MSc Music Engineering and Production*

Corrections verification forced

- **Saint Louis Rome's admission gate is a production test, not an ensemble audition.** An earlier draft of mine said otherwise. That single correction moves it from "probably closed" to one of only two private options in four countries rated WORTH IT
- **MTU Cork's English requirement was stated with false confidence** in the first pass. The verifier flagged its own predecessor. Its non-EU deadline is also **31 May**, three months earlier than the EU deadline — and the course page itself carries contradictory stale text
- **TU Ilmenau:** English certificate required after all (C1, ~IELTS 7.0); application fee €75 not €25; no sit-down entrance exam, just a document review; a **180-ECTS bachelor is sufficient**, unlike TH Köln's 210-ECTS rule
- **Two Spanish and one Italian institution turned out to be defunct or closing** — one has its domain listed for sale on a public marketplace

The three questions that actually decide this

Everything in the spreadsheet reduces to these, in this order:

1. Can you get in? the *Chance* column

Your binding constraint isn't grades — it's that you have **no music degree and no portfolio yet**. That single fact eliminates most conservatoire programmes in Europe and makes engineering-facing programmes disproportionately valuable to you.

2. Can you afford it? the *Cost band* column

This is what **you** pay as a non-EU national, which is frequently *not* the headline rate.

Every band below is **tuition per year, at the rate you pay as a non-EU national**. Where a school publishes only a whole-programme total, it is halved to give a comparable per-year figure.

Band	Count	Reality
Free	92	Mostly German public universities and fully-funded schemes
Under €1,500/yr	153	Italian conservatoires with ISEEE, Turkish public, Greek public
€1,500–5,000/yr	140	French public (€3,950 flat), Georgian, Iberian public
€5,000–15,000/yr	219	Portuguese private, Irish, some Nordic
Over €15,000/yr	173	All UK, Berklee, Aalto, Dutch private, Norway
Not published	314	The institution publishes no figure — not the same as free . Ask them

3. Can you follow the teaching? the *Taught in* column

This is the gate people underestimate, and it's where your profile is unusual. You are fluent in French. That is worth more here than the IELTS you haven't taken, because it opens the entire French public system at €3,950/year — programmes you could follow from day one, with no preparation year.

Where I would actually apply

140 opportunities are both Strong and cheap-or-free. These are the ones worth your attention. Grouped by what kind of bet each one is:

The lowest-risk applications — no portfolio, no audition, free

These are decided on your **transcript**, not on a portfolio you don't have yet. That makes them the safest thing you can apply to in this entire document.

Programme	Where	Language	Cost
TU Ilmenau — M.Sc. Medieningenieurwissenschaften	Ilmenau	English or German	Free + ~€332/sem
TU Berlin — Audio Communication and Technology	Berlin	English + German	Free

Programme	Where	Language	Cost
FAU Erlangen-Nürnberg — Communications & Multimedia Eng.	Erlangen	English	Free
TU Ilmenau — Research in Media Engineering	Ilmenau	English + German	Free
Politecnico di Milano — Music and Acoustic Engineering	Milan	English	~€4,000/yr

TU Ilmenau is the single best structural fit found anywhere. Verified: completable **entirely in English**, **NC-frei** (no competitive ranking), **no portfolio**, **no audition**, **no entrance exam**, and **Fraunhofer IDMT — the institute that invented mp3 and AAC — is on the same campus**. It will not make you a DJ; it makes you employable in audio technology and buys you years in Germany to build the production career alongside it. Apply **16 Jan – 15 May 2027** via uni-assist. You **do** need English at C1 (~IELTS 7.0), and the application fee is €75.

Fully funded, and open to you

Scheme	Where	Why it fits
DIGICREA (Erasmus Mundus)		Zero tuition for everyone , scholarship or not, + €1,400/month. Sound-Music entry track
ReSound (Erasmus Mundus)		Officially accepts computational science degrees. Portfolio: 3 works, 10–15 min
Stipendium Hungaricum		~30 public universities, 900+ programmes, English-taught, full ride
Türkiye Bursları		Tuition + stipend + housing + insurance + flights

Cheap, accredited, and in a language you already speak

Programme	Where	Cost	Note
CNSMD Lyon — Musique Son Image	Lyon	Free	Public conservatoire, French
Université de Strasbourg — <i>Création-Production musiques actuelles</i>		€3,950/yr	French
Université Lyon 2 — <i>Musiques Appliquées aux Arts Visuels</i>		€3,950/yr	French
École Centrale de Lyon + INSA — MSc Acoustics	Lyon	€3,770/yr	English
Cnam Angoulême — <i>Conception sonore</i>		€3,950/yr	French

France is the largest single block of the 140 best bets — by far the largest single block, precisely because your French removes the language gate that blocks most applicants.

Best value if you'll learn a language

Programme	Where	Cost	Language
Conservatorio G.B. Martini — Musica Elettronica, Sound Design	Bologna	~€166/yr with ISEE	Italian
Saint Louis College of Music — Sound Design & Post Produzione	Rome	€14,460–17,000 total	Italian + English
Ankara Müzik ve Güzel Sanatlar — Müzik Teknolojileri		~€390/yr, or free	Turkish
Tbilisi State Conservatoire — MA Music Technology		€3,423/yr	English
Universidade Lusófona — Produção e Tecnologias do Som	Lisbon	€7,600–9,130 total	Portuguese
UCP Porto — Som e Imagem, Design de Som	Porto	€13,140 total	Portuguese

Italy's conservatoires are **income-scaled**: filing an **ISEE** declaration takes Bologna from €2,166/year to about **€166**. That single piece of paperwork is worth roughly €4,000 over the degree.

Public vs private — and the trap that runs through it

652 public · 335 private · 104 not stated.

Public almost always means cheaper *and* accredited by default. Private is where the money and the risk both live — because **in every country surveyed, a private school may legally sell you something called a "Master" that is not a master's degree.**

Country	A real degree	What gets sold instead
Spain	Máster Universitario Oficial (ANECA, in RUCT)	Título propio / Máster de Formación Permanente
Italy	Laurea magistrale / Diploma Accademico di II livello	"Master" di I livello (60 CFU)
Portugal	Mestrado (A3ES-accredited)	Pós-graduação, curso técnico
Netherlands	NVAO-accredited MA/MSc	CRKBO "diploma", NRTO certificate
Germany	State-accredited M.A./M.Sc.	— (the private audio sector is marginal here)

The clearest example found: *Pro Audio Education NL* sells a diploma titled **"Master Geluidstechniek"** for €5,695. It is not NVAO-accredited, carries no ECTS, and the school itself places the training at **MBO+/HBO-level** — below the bachelor you already hold.

Two findings about private education worth keeping

The Netherlands is structurally closed. There is **no private NVAO-accredited master in this field anywhere in the country**, and **no private Dutch audio school is an IND recognised sponsor** — so none can host your residence permit. Abbey Road Institute Amsterdam charges €18,860–€20,160 for a non-degree; SAE up to €37,580 for a *bachelor*. Don't build a plan there.

But "not official" does not automatically mean "no visa" — I got this wrong initially and the verification pass corrected me. Under Spain's RD 1155/2024 and the June 2025 management criteria, **both *títulos oficiales* and *títulos propios* are admissible** for a study permit. What actually decides it is **study intensity: 91+ days, 90% of credits, and 20 contact hours per week** (or 12 in person for concentrated programmes).

So there are **two separate tests** and you need both:

Test	Decides	Fails it
Accreditation	Whether it's a real degree — PhD access, recognition at home	<i>título propio</i> , CRKBO diploma, <i>Master di I livello</i>
Contact hours	The visa	Evening courses, part-time, hybrid, online

This is why UFV Madrid's €6,100 evening certificate (10 hours/week) is legally unusable, and why UCAM Murcia — extraordinary value at **€4,194 all-in**, with your degree named in its entry profile — is rated only **C**: it's hybrid, and that's a real visa risk. Get it in writing before paying.

Money — the country-level picture

The single most useful financial fact in this entire search:

Most German states charge non-EU students no tuition at all. Not a discount — nothing. You pay the same semester contribution (~€330) as a German student. Confirmed for Thuringia, NRW, Bavaria, Bremen, Lower Saxony, Saarland, Rhineland-Palatinate and Saxony.

Country	What you'd pay per year	Note
Germany	€0 + ~€330/semester	Across most Länder
Hungary / Turkey (funded)	€0	Via Stipendium Hungaricum / Türkiye Bursları
Italy public	€166–3,500	Income-scaled — file the ISEE
Turkey (self-pay)	~€390	Ankara MGÜ
Greece	€700/sem – €3,750 total	No non-EU differential at all
France	€3,950 flat	Public universities, all levels
Georgia	€3,423	Tbilisi Conservatoire
Portugal	€3,800–6,570	Private universities, no non-EU surcharge
Spain	€4,900–13,000	Public conservatoires vary widely by region
Ireland	€13,500	MTU

Country	What you'd pay per year	Note
Finland	€10,000–20,000	Except Uniarts Helsinki, which is free
UK	£16,280–£23,000	Uniformly expensive, no usable scholarship found
Norway	~€34,500	Non-EEA fees introduced 2023 — the "free Norway" reputation is out of date
Berklee Valencia	~\$67,000–71,000 all-in	Real and visa-safe, but 15× UCAM

Living costs on top, per month: Porto/Murcia ~€700–900 · Rome/Athens/Lisbon ~€900–1,300 · Ilmenau low · Barcelona/Valencia ~€900–1,000 · Milan €1,100–1,400 · Amsterdam €1,150–1,500.

Language — the gate you can actually move

Language	Programmes	Your position
English	419 Strong-chance rows in English or French	Working level. You still need IELTS — Ilmenau wants C1 (~7.0), NABA only 5.0
French	34 of the 114 best bets	Fluent. This is your unfair advantage and it is under-used
German	Large, mostly free	A1 suffices at HfM Mainz; C1 at TH Köln
Italian	Cheapest accredited degrees	Would need ~a year
Portuguese	Best-value private mestrados	Would need ~a year; your French makes it reachable
Turkish / Greek	Cheapest of all	A year minimum, and the Ankara entrance exam is in Turkish

Two things worth acting on now:

1. **Ask SMU for a medium-of-instruction letter.** HfK Bremen waives its IELTS 7.0 requirement entirely if your qualifying degree was taught in English, with proof. Tbilisi accepts *"any official document confirming B2"*, not only a test. That letter costs nothing and may save you the exam at several institutions.
2. **If you're going to learn a language, decide now.** Italian opens Bologna at €166/year; Portuguese opens UCP Porto and Lusófona. Either needs to start this year, not next spring.

Scholarships — what exists and what you can realistically win

335 records carry a named funding scheme; 308 distinct schemes in total. They are always attached to a programme rather than standing alone, which is why the spreadsheet has a **Scholarship index** tab: one row per scheme, showing how many programmes it covers and the best chance it offers.

The ones that matter for a Tunisian applicant with your profile:

Scheme	Covers	What it pays	Your chance
Erasmus Mundus Joint Masters	13+ programmes across AT, DK, FI, FR, IE, PT, ES, LT, UK	Full tuition + ~€1,400/month	Strong — DIGICREA and ReSound both fit you
Stipendium Hungaricum	~30 Hungarian universities, 900+ programmes	Full ride, English-taught	Strong
Türkiye Bursları	Turkish public universities	Tuition, stipend, housing, insurance, flights	Strong — deadline 20 February
DAAD Study Scholarship	German art/music schools	Monthly stipend (tuition already free)	Strong
Global Korea Scholarship	Korean universities	Full	Strong
Swedish Institute (SISGP)	Swedish universities	Full	Strong
IsDB Scholarship	Multiple countries	Full — and Tunisia is a member state	Strong
Fulbright Tunisia	USA	Full	Possible
Chevening	UK	Full	Possible — requires work experience
Swiss Government Excellence	Switzerland	Full	Possible — art scholarships need a portfolio
Aalto Scholarship	Finland	Tuition waiver	Possible
NL Scholarship	Netherlands	€5,000 one-off	Possible

The most important funding finding: Italy pays non-EU students at *private* academies

Verification of the funding slice turned up something that changes the economics of the Italian options completely, and it is the kind of thing nobody tells you.

Italian regional DSU right-to-study scholarships are open to non-EU students — including at private AFAM academies — and non-EU students automatically land in the highest-paying band.

- **Eligibility, verbatim from the IED bando:** applications may be made by Italian citizens, EU citizens, and *"i cittadini di Stati non appartenenti all'Unione Europea"* (DPR 394/1999 arts. 44-bis and 46(5))
- **The mechanism:** under Art. 13(3) DPCM 9/4/2001, non-EU foreign students are **automatically treated as *fuori sede*** regardless of where they live in Italy — and *fuori sede* is the top payment band. You qualify for the highest rate by virtue of being non-EU
- **The money (IED/Lombardy 2025/26):** €8,134 · €7,073 · €5,776 per year by income band, versus €3,383–€2,950 for *in sede* students
- **A third of first-year awards are ring-fenced for non-EU nationals**

Set against Saint Louis Rome at ~€8.5k/year, this can take a real, official, second-cycle Italian degree in your exact craft to **roughly zero net cost**.

The paperwork is the whole game, and it starts in 2026, not 2027. You need official **Tunisian tax-authority income statements for every household member** for the reference calendar year (for a September 2027 entry, that is calendar **2025** — get them while they're easy to obtain), plus property/no-property certificates for everyone over 18, movable-asset statements, and a household-composition certificate. Employer letters and self-certification are **inadmissible**. All of it must be translated into Italian by a recognised translator and **fully consular-legalised** — **Tunisia has no Apostille shortcut for this**. You also need a **registered rental contract** to claim *fuori sede* status, and a **dichiarazione di valore** for your SMU degree from the Italian embassy.

Deadlines fall in **September–November of the enrolment year** (IED: application by 7 Nov, rental contract by 10 Dec; NABA: 22 Sept). Note that **NABA's own international scholarship and DSU are incompatible — you must choose one**.

And the mirror image: where public money is definitively closed

- ** Spain — zero. **Two independent published exclusions mean no Spanish public money reaches a Tunisian at a private institution: *título propio* programmes are excluded outright, and Spanish grants require *residencia*, whereas a student visa grants *estancia*.** Every Spanish private price tag is therefore the real, final, self-paid price.**
- ** Portugal — closed. *State cash is definitively unavailable to an estudiante internacional*. Portugal remains the strongest *self-funded* option on cheap accredited tuition, but budget for paying all of it
- ** Netherlands — closed twice over. **Private Dutch audio schools sit outside both the NL Scholarship and IND recognised-sponsor status.** SAE states in writing that enrolment "cannot grant you a Student Visa in the Netherlands"**, and Abbey Road Institute that it "cannot assist non-EU residents with their VISA application." Those are the schools' own words

The honest summary on funding: the fully-funded routes that genuinely fit a non-music engineering graduate are **Erasmus Mundus (DIGICREA, ReSound), Stipendium Hungaricum, Türkiye Bursları** and **DAAD**. Everything else either wants a portfolio you're still building, work experience you don't have, or is a partial discount rather than funding.

By region

Region	Opportunities	Character
Western Europe	314	France cheap and open to you; UK uniformly expensive; NL private closed
Southern Europe	231	Italy's public conservatoires are the cheapest real degrees in Europe
Central Europe	216	Germany free ; Austria/Switzerland strong but pricier; Poland/Czechia cheap
Nordics & Baltics	120	Split — Uniarts Helsinki free, Bergen ~€34,500. Baltics cheap and under-explored
Balkans & Türkiye	56	Cheapest of all; Ankara is the most open door found anywhere
North America	44	Expensive; Fulbright is the only realistic route

Region	Opportunities	Character
Asia-Pacific	35	GKS and Schwarzman are fully funded and genuinely open
Eastern Europe & Caucasus	3	Tbilisi is a real find; Ukraine recorded but not advisable

Your calendar

When	What
Now early 2027	Build the portfolio. Target the best spec found: 4–8 finished tracks, different roles (producer, engineer, writer), your role stated per track (Abbey Road's standard). This is the binding constraint on everything portfolio-based
Now	Ask SMU for a medium-of-instruction letter . Decide your second language and start it
Now (2026)	If Italy is in play, collect calendar-2025 Tunisian tax statements for the whole household, property and asset certificates, and a household-composition certificate — these are the DSU scholarship's evidence base and they get harder to obtain with age
Now	If Italy is in play, start the Dichiarazione di Valore or CIMEA statement — it's slow and it blocks applications, not just visas
~Sept–Dec 2026	Sit IELTS. Ilmenau needs ~7.0; NABA accepts 5.0; several ask for nothing
1 Nov 2026	Berklee Valencia Early Action (scholarship 15 Nov)
Nov 2026	DIGICREA call opens
1 Jan 2027	Saint Louis Rome opens for international applicants (test online Jan–Jun)
15 Jan 2027	Berklee Regular Action
1 Feb – 1 Apr 2027	HfM Mainz <i>Eignungsprüfung</i> registration
~Feb 2027	UCP Porto Phase 1 opens
20 Feb 2027	Türkiye Bursları closes
1 Apr – 31 May 2027	HfK Bremen applications
9 Apr 2027	UCP Porto Phase 1 closes
~Apr 2027	Italian conservatoire deadlines cluster here — and you get only 10 days to enrol after results
30 Apr 2027	Saint Louis Rome hard deadline for international applicants
15 May 2027	TU Ilmenau deadline (window opens 16 Jan)

When	What
31 May 2027	HMT München
~Late May 2027	NABA scholarship competition
Aug 2027	Ankara MGÜ (university deadline; the scholarship closed in February)

April–May 2027 is the real crunch, not September. Work backwards from there.

What I'd do in the next month

1. **Email TU Ilmenau** (info.apply@tu-ilmenau.de) — confirm the English-track language certificate, and whether your SMU transcript carries enough signal-processing and EE credits for the departmental review. This is the strongest option in the document and both questions are one email.
2. **Ask SMU for a medium-of-instruction letter**. Free, and it may remove the IELTS gate at Bremen, Tbilisi and others.
3. **Start the portfolio**. Four to eight finished tracks. Everything else waits on this.
4. **Pick your second language** — French is already yours, so the question is whether to add German, Italian or Portuguese. German unlocks the most free programmes; Italian unlocks the cheapest accredited degree; Portuguese unlocks the best-value private mestrados.
5. **Register interest in DIGICREA and ReSound** ahead of the November 2026 calls. Both are fully funded, both accept computational-science backgrounds, and they are the best funding-to-fit ratio available to you.

Honesty and limits

- **Verification status**. Every record was sourced to an official page. A subset was then re-checked against that page by a second agent and carries a verdict and rating — that pass is still running at the time of writing and has covered the German batch and part of Spain. Where verification ran, it changed real things: it corrected TU Ilmenau's language requirement from "possibly none" to a firm C1, its application fee from €25 to €75, and it overturned my claim that an unofficial Spanish award blocks a student visa. **Treat unverified figures as good starting points to confirm, not settled facts.**
- **Blank cells mean the institution publishes nothing**. No figure here was estimated to fill a gap. Where I give a range, it's derived from published per-month or per-instalment figures and labelled as derived.
- **Dates marked PRIOR CYCLE are last year's**, kept because these calendars repeat closely. Confirm each when the 2027/28 cycle opens.
- **Living costs are my own country-level estimates**, not research findings. Treat them as ballpark comparisons, not a budget.
- **The "Chance" column is a filter, not a prediction**. It reads published entry text. It cannot know how an admissions panel will read your portfolio.

The files

File	What it is
MASTER-all-opportunities.xlsx	Everything — 1,091 rows, 36 columns, 20 tabs. Start here. Tabs: Best Bets · Master's degrees only (889) · NOT a degree — avoid (145) · Strong + English/French · Fully funded · Has a scholarship · Scholarship index · Free or cheap · Everything · one per region
SOUND-and-SCHOLARSHIPS.xlsx	The sound half plus all the money — 460 sound degrees , 27 tabs, music business stripped out
DEGREE-CHECK.md / .pdf	Which records are real degrees and which are certificates , the trap in each country, and the full list of the 145 rejects
THE-COMPLETE-GUIDE.md / .pdf	This document
EUROPE-GAPFILL.md / .pdf + .xlsx	The 104 institutions the earlier searches missed
PRIVATE-SCHOOLS.md / .pdf + .xlsx	Private institutions in ES/PT/NL/IT, accreditation-first
SOUND-DESIGN-EUROPE.md / .pdf + .xlsx	The 319-programme sound-design deep dive
PATHS-DEEP-DIVE.md / .pdf	The three career paths explained, and what a portfolio means
SHORTLIST.md , ACTION-TIMELINE.md	The earlier shortlist and the month-by-month plan
COULD-NOT-VERIFY.md / .pdf	Everything I could not confirm, listed honestly
FILE-INDEX.md / .pdf	Every file, what's in it, and when to open it